

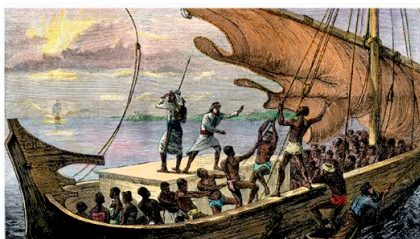
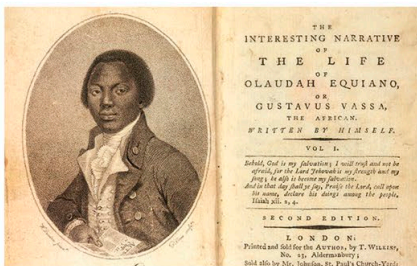
1788-1807

THE END OF THE SLAVE TRADE

From the 16th to the 19th centuries, an estimated 12 million Africans were forcibly transported across the Atlantic to the Americas, where they were sold as slaves. As this trade grew in the 18th century, reaching a peak in 1750-1800, so did arguments for its abolition based on moral and economic grounds. Black people took up leading roles in the fight to end the institution that systematically dehumanized them for profit. In the 17th century, Angolan prince Lourenço da Silva Mendonça travelled to Rome to convince the Pope to end the slave trade, and in

1792, *The York Herald* reported that Africans had blown up the slave ship *Le Couleur* on the coast of Guinea.

Guerrilla actions, such as arson and poisoning, were a threat to plantation owners, while open revolts such as that in Saint-Domingue (see below) made the establishment question the viability of slavery. Formerly enslaved people added their voices to the growing movement for abolition. The slave trade was outlawed in Britain 1807, but more than a million Africans were illicitly shipped across the Atlantic after this date.



KEY MOMENTS

1788 Slave Trade Act

After lobbying by the Sons of Africa, a group of 12 Black men including Olaudah Equiano (left), and the Society for the Abolition of the Slave Trade, Britain passed a law regulating the Atlantic slave trade, limiting the number of people British ships could transport.

1791-1804 Haitian Revolution

Formerly enslaved Toussaint Louverture led thousands of enslaved people in the colony of Saint-Domingue (left) to victory over European colonial armies to establish Haiti as the first independent Black republic in the Americas.

1807 Abolition of the Slave Trade Act

In March 1807, Britain became the first major European nation to abolish the slave trade. However, British slave merchants found ways to circumvent the ban using intermediaries (left), and slavery itself remained legal in Britain's colonies until 1833.

